

The Best Advice I Ever Got

BALBIR SINGH DHILLON | HEAD | AUDI INDIA

Audi India is the Indian arm of the premium German car brand



‘Don’t reinvent the wheel; see what it can do’

What was the problem you were grappling with?

When Audi India decided to bring the Audi e-tron to India, I was excited but equally anxious. Electric vehicles (EVs) are a shift in personal mobility, and customer concerns like charging infrastructure, range anxiety and the overall awareness quotient were fundamental areas to be addressed.

Who did you approach for advice and why?

I took inspiration from a book. The book that helped me was *Screw It, Let's Do It: Lessons in Life* by Richard Branson. It's hard to read about the journey of a storied businessman like Richard Branson and not catch the motivational bug and zest for life.

What was the advice you received?

Reading about Branson's life allowed me to view the problem or challenge in a more positive light. It reaffirmed my thoughts and ideas on the strategy and what I wanted to achieve. To address this challenge, it was important that I didn't reinvent the wheel, but look at what the actual problems were and how those could be addressed without complicating the system. So, at Audi we created an app ecosystem around EV knowledge sharing with information about charging infra, after-sales service, warranty, buyback and even battery recycling for our e-tron customers.

How effective was it in resolving the problem?

I can proudly say that we have received an overwhelming response for the e-tron brand in India. Today, we are the only brand in India that sells five electric cars [in the luxury segment]. We launched all these between July and September 2021, and what a journey it has been! Our cars are sold out even before they reach Indian shores and we have a strong order book for the next few months. **BT**

—ABHIJ SEN

Vol. 31, No. 12 for the fortnight
May 30, 2022 to June 12, 2022. Released
on May 30, 2022.
Total number of pages 100 (including cover)